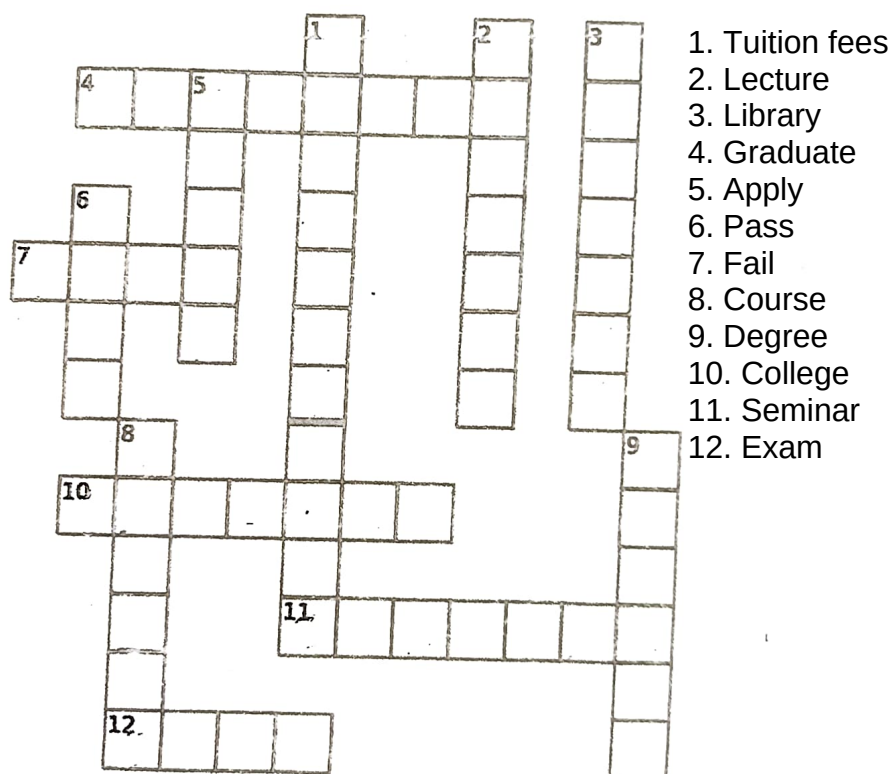


American and British Universities: vocabulary

15 October 2021

1. How many words can you remember from the presentation? Complete the crossword to test your memory.



Across 4 Finish university 7 To not succeed in a test 10 What Americans often call university
11 A class with small groups of students 12 A long test to see how much you know about a subject
Down 1 Money paid to study at university 2 A class at university with a large number of students
3 Where students can work and borrow books 5 Officially ask for a place at university 6 Succeed in a test
8 A series of classes on the same subject 9 A university qualification

② Complete the sentences with words from the crossword

1. If you're unsure what to do after you **graduate** from university, you should talk to a careers adviser who will help you decide on the next steps after completing your studies.
2. Some of my favourite **COURSES** include Spanish, Russian and linguistics. And my least favourite? Literature, history and geography.
3. During the **seminar** the instructor put students in small groups to work together on chemistry problems and went around the class to give them help.
4. Yale, Harvard, Stanford and UC Berkeley are among the best **colleges** in the US.
5. A grade of C or above is required to successfully **pass** the final test. If you get less than that, you will **fail** the test, and you have to repeat the course.
6. It's 2am, and you feel an urgent need to borrow a book or get some work done? No problem, the **library** is open around the clock for all your study needs.
7. Today's animal biology **lecture** was all about the behaviour of domestic cats. It was attended by over a hundred students and cat lovers.
8. Many students **apply** to Oxford and Cambridge each year, but few are eventually admitted to these selective universities.
9. The rising cost of **tuition fees** in the US is a major problem for students and their families, who often have to borrow money to pay for college.
10. The end-of-year Spanish **exam** was quite a challenge. We had a long and difficult text to translate, followed by over a page of grammar exercises. And we had to do it all in just 3 hours, without a dictionary!
11. After studying for four years at Cal, she received her first **degree** in computer science. Two years later, she got another one in engineering from Imperial College in London.

✎ Your turn: write five sentences using the new vocabulary.

I passed the exams to obtain a degree from one of the best colleges of the US.

Harvard students

 Reading
Let's Meet Up, p. 518

9–12 November 2021

 Read the text once and answer the question.

1. Where is Harvard University?
2. What subjects does Raphaëlle study?

 Read the text again. Work on the questions in groups.

3. Say if the following statements are true or false. Justify your answers.
 - (a) Harvard owes its reputation to being an old and elitist institution.
 - (b) Students at Harvard often have many activities outside of class.
 - (c) Raphaëlle's economics class on Wednesday is at 12pm.
 - (d) Raphaëlle has a part-time job on top of her studies.
 - (e) Before dinner, Raphaëlle takes an economics review test.
 - (f) After her debating club, Raphaëlle goes back to the library to finish coursework.
 - (g) Raphaëlle doesn't get much sleep at night.
 - (h) Harvard students don't have any spare time.
4. List Raphaëlle's activities on a typical Wednesday, including the time and location if possible.

 Writing

5. Imagine you are a student at Harvard University. Describe a typical day in your life on campus. What courses do you attend? Do you spend a lot of time in the library? Do you have time for extracurricular activities?



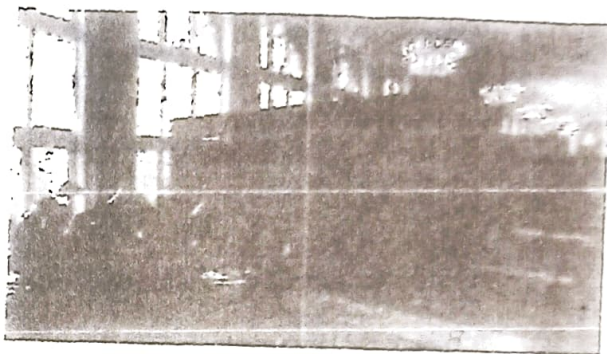
Raphaëlle describes a typical day in the life of a Harvard University student and examines the reasons why Harvard has such a high reputation.

I now know why Harvard has its reputation as one of the top universities in the world. It is not because Harvard is an elitist institution, or because it is one of the oldest colleges in the US. It is because every single student here works incredibly hard, spending long nights studying and taking multiple extracurricular activities. Time is the currency here, with students valuing it more than anything else.

There is not one hour of the day, be it midday or midnight, that the libraries remain unoccupied or the dorm buildings turn fully dark. To try to demonstrate how busy each day is, I'm going to describe one typical Wednesday for me.

My first class is at the Kennedy School of Government at 8:45 a.m. I then study in the library for an hour, go to my economics class at noon and then rush out to grab lunch. For the following five hours, I work at the Weatherhead Centre for International Affairs as a research assistant to a postdoctoral fellow³ focusing on the voting habits and the suffrage movement in Denmark.

After eating dinner, I take an economics review test. Once that is completed, I attend the weekly Institute of Politics meeting with the Harvard Political Union and listen and engage in debate for an hour. I then reboot with coffee, return to study at the library and



◆ Students in the library at Harvard, 2019

attempt to wade through the multiple books, essays and assignments due for Friday. Somewhere between the busyness of the day and the night activities, I try to find the time to sleep.

My typical day is by no means unique, or more work intensive than any other student's schedule. A flustered⁴ and half frantic⁵-looking freshman racing across Harvard Yard to get to the next class on time is a common sight⁶.

However, we are not robots, delighting in a constant cycle of reading, writing and calculating. Through the hard work and long hours, Harvard students manage to create free time to socialise, party, date and explore Boston.

◆ Raphaëlle Soffe, timeshighereducation.com, 2017

1. outside of class 2. money 3. researcher 4. upset and confused 5. almost out of control 6. occurrence